You want a happy team and you want a team that can deliver. Another way to find out what good thresholds are for your team is to focus on what went into good software releases to figure out how to tune your process to replicate that success. In this case you can filter your data by anything that went into a release that worked well to find the key data points. As we did with tags in the previous examples, you can then look at the resulting watermarks to see what behavior went into a particular release.

In the next example we'll look at the tale of two releases: a pretty good release and a painful release. First, we'll look at the painful release.

The painful release looked great during the development cycle. The team was focusing on development time and trying to keep it to a minimum. They had a huge push to get the release out the door, and when they did the bugs started rolling in. Nagging issues caused a long support tail of nearly two months of fixing problems. The resulting charts are shown in figure 7.5.

Figure 7.5. Stats around a painful release. Even though development time looked great, there were nagging bugs that caused hot fixes over a long period.